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LETTERS TO MY SON

On Wisdom

16 letters

Father

A father's letters, worth keeping.

A word before you begin

My son,

Knowledge fills the mind; wisdom governs the life. These letters are on learning that changes how you live, not merely what you know.

Read one a day. Sit with it. Let it change one small thing in how you live.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Read deeply, not widely.

A mind scattered across a hundred books holds none of them.

Sit with few authors until they become part of you.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Knowledge of the world is gained among people, not in the study alone.

Books give you the map; the street teaches you to walk it.

Close the book sometimes and watch.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

To know the good and not do it is the most useless learning.

Wisdom you do not live is merely decoration.

Let every truth you learn change one act.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The half-learned man is the loudest in the room.

Real knowledge wears quietly; it has nothing to prove.

Carry what you know like a watch, shown only when asked.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Each day, take one idea and chew it until it is yours.

A single truth digested beats a hundred swallowed whole.

Learn less, but keep it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The wisest inheritance is the ability to think, not the answer to copy.

Hand your son questions worth carrying, not just conclusions to obey.

Teach him to reason and he will outgrow your advice.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A teacher learns more than his student, if he is honest.

Explaining a thing reveals every gap you pretended to fill.

Teach what you wish to truly know.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Master one field deeply before you dabble in ten.

The world rewards the man who is excellent somewhere, not adequate everywhere.

Go deep first; range can come after.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Knowledge you cannot act on is a heavy, useless cargo.

The point of learning was never to know, but to live differently.

Let each truth change one habit.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Hold fast to one good author until he becomes part of your thinking.

The mind that flits from book to book is fed but never nourished.

Stay long enough to be changed.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The best thing you can give an heir is the capacity to
decide well.

Hand down judgement, and he will make his own fortune
and his own way.

Teach the choosing, not just the choice.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Do not laugh at another man's fall.

Study it, for his lesson is one you can learn without paying.

Collect other men's mistakes like free tuition.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Read few books, but read them until they are part of you.

A mind spread across a hundred titles keeps none of them.

Go deep; depth is what changes a man.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

They never tell you this — Read deeply, not widely.

A mind scattered across a hundred books holds none of them.

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Father

Keep going

If these served you, there is more.

- A new letter every day — @letters_to_son_eng
- The weekly letter — comment LETTERS to join.
- The full collection and printed keepsakes — coming soon.

Carry these well. One day you may write your own.

Yours faithfully,

Father